

ViewSonic Va2216W*Decent for movies*

The cheaper brother of the VX2255WM, the Va2216W is simple looking and a bit lighter.



The stand is simple as well, and although small does a good job keeping this rather large beast well and truly grounded. With a rated contrast ratio that is less than its costlier sibling we figure ViewSonic ought to have dropped in a cheaper panel into this one. As expected whatever the VX2255WM does, this one does with a little less aplomb. Its contrast ratio isn't too bad, but will be a little deficient in games like *F.E.A.R.*, and our DisplayMate tests showed a slight issue with colour rendition of the green in the 256 intensity ramp test. The blues and reds were good enough though. One nicety is the very decent performance in movies, and it's very close to its costlier sibling here, and makes a good choice for multimedia aficionados—unless you're really discerning. At Rs 13,500 the Va2216W makes a strong case for itself in the value market, except that the SP 2208 WFP is a lot more monitor for a slightly higher price.

Samsung SyncMaster 2253LW*Pricey performer*

A very narrow bezel, great build quality, a sleek stand, and a Bordeaux-like slick piano black finish mean this monitor looks timelessly hot. The transparent fibre bezel on the bottom catches the power on/off buttons blue LED light and it looks as if the bezel itself is illuminated—neat! Don't go by the Dynamic Contrast Ratio of 8000:1 mentioned on the top bezel. We figure the actual static ratio is more like 800:1 which is very good by the way. The menu system is uncluttered and very intuitive; the controlling buttons are easy to use. This moni-

tor features a matte panel (thank you God!), a blessing after the SP 2208 WFP. In DisplayMate it outshone the Dell in the Intensity Range Check where it displayed even more grey cards. The performance in all other DisplayMate tests was very good, although the Dell seemed to be as good in the 256 shade ramp test. Colour rendition is good if not as vivid as the Dell's colours, but this is a great panel for movie watching and our HD clips looked amazing, with ample contrast. In *Oblivion*, the outdoors look resplendently alive with detailing and textur-



ing, great HDR and contrast once again. Even the gloomy interiors of *F.E.A.R.* were no issue for this monitor, except for a couple of dark spots where the contrast seems to be a touch deficient.

With good performance across the board, and a great matte panel accompanied by some fine build quality and designer looks, the 2253LW is a great LCD all round. A price of Rs 17,500 is lower than the inferior HP monitor, but more expensive than any other monitor in this size category. It is the best monitor of the 22-inch lot, albeit by a small margin. You decide if the premium is worth the performance.

19-inch Monitors
One size too small?**AOC 913FW***Standing tall...*

With the most unique stand of all, the 913FW looks more like an LCD TV than a monitor. We were surprised to see how firm this sits on a desk with just a little nub like protrusion for a stand—great design by AOC. Even the front bezel looks slick, with a contoured fascia. The menu system is good, although the navigating buttons are a little confusing. Our DisplayMate tests showed



very good performance in the geometry tests and decent performance in the contrast and brightness tests. The colour tests were rather uneventful other than a slight discrepancy in the rendition of green and red in the 16 shade ramp test. Overall a satisfactory performance for a TN panel based LCD. We were surprised to see the contrast ratio being the main deterrent in our movie tests, especially noticeable with darker screens and areas where light and dark areas interact, like a scene with leaves dappled in sunlight moving in and out of bright spots of sunlight due to the breeze. It performed decently in our gaming tests, although as usual *F.E.A.R.* was a little too much for a TN panel, and we felt the contrast deficient by a decent margin. The colour and effects looked good.

For a price of Rs 9,600 the 913FW is a great looking monitor that will fetch more than a single glance. A great price, a decent performer with a look that demands a desk upgrade. What's not to like?—nothing unless you're a discerning gamer or a serious movie junkie.

AOC 917VW*Plain Jane*

The 917VW is one of those fairly inconspicuous looking products that is never going to get a lot of attention. It features a well laid out menu and good build quality with great finish of materials. In our DisplayMate tests we found performance to lag behind its identically-priced sibling the 913FW, a weird showing, especially since we figured both LCDs used the same panels. We missed out on quite a few grey cards in our Intensity Check test, and the contrast ratio generally felt a little deficient. What was a noticeable problem was the reverse text tests, especially with the colours yellow and green. Performance in the colour inten-

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sity tests was acceptable, but not commendable. *F.E.A.R.* showed a noticeable lack of contrast, as did the darkest dungeons of *Oblivion*. Our movie tests fared a little better with decent colour, although the contrast issue still rears its head. At the same price (Rs 9,600) as its sibling, we suggest you go for the better-looking and performing 913FW, unless it's too loud for your office environment, in which case the 917VW will fit the bill.

ASUS PG191*Bassy stand...eh?*

We reviewed the same monitor last year. It features a stand heavy enough to knock Godzilla silly, which cunningly incorporates a 10 watt RMS speaker unit with a subwoofer that delivers good sound, the best we've heard from inbuilt LCD speakers. To say this panel is



well built is an understatement, although it's not a widescreen. The soft touch buttons are as annoying as they are nifty—the problem is that they don't work as they should. We missed a lot of touches—irritating!

The dated TN panel in this monitor shows up a few issues with contrast in DisplayMate. After that we had a few more issues with geometry which were

rectified with judicious use of the calibration tool. In terms of colour performance it's a mixed bag with accurate rendition of primary colours at the expense of some issues in the 16 shade intensity test. *F.E.A.R.* and *Oblivion* sport great detail and the effects and colour look really good on this monitor, and unless you're in one of those shadowy areas the lack of contrast won't be very noticeable. The lack of widescreen will annoy you when watching HD content, but the quality itself was satisfactory. With a good webcam adding value to an already good offering the only possible goof up could be the price. Rs 26,990 is too much to pay for a 19 inch, monitor. Heck...its too much to pay for a 22-inch monitor. Enough said...

Dell 1908FP*Great stand meets mediocre screen*

Its great build, combination of colours, excellent stand and height adjust, and the fact that it has a portrait mode are all facts that simply grab you by the throat and force you to accept this as a serious contender for your cash, if you happen to be shopping for a non-widescreen 19-inch LCD. DisplayMate showcases



some issues with contrast first and colours later. This monitor has issues with the shade intensity tests, a testament to a mediocre TN panel behind the scenes. *F.E.A.R.* had a good time thrashing this panel, although we must say the colours were rather good in the game, but the contrast (or lack of it) will annoy you throughout. As with the PG191 movie watching isn't recommended on a non-widescreen. There was also a slight issue with pixel response time as our movie tests revealed. At a price of Rs 14,000, the 1908FP offers a great number of features not seen on monitors this cheap.

If only its performance was really great we'd have recommended it with our eyes closed. For now, it makes sense as a solution for an office or Internet PC.

HP L1950*More of the flexible stand*

The L1950 is a hunk of a monitor with a colossal stand that allows you to pivot and swivel and even orient it flat, face up. It's got supreme build quality and a matte finish looks elegant, but to many the stand looks like a foldable plastic Eiffel Tower. Once calibrated on DisplayMate we noticed some good performance in the



geometry and contrast tests. With a good showing of the primary and secondary colours the L1950 even did reasonably well in the shade ramp tests making it suitable for professional users (image editing, rendering etc). The flexibility of the stand means it can even be used by office goers for presentations of all sorts—decent viewing angles also help here. *F.E.A.R.* was close to its atmospheric best with baddies visible even in the depth of shadow, and the exteriors of *Oblivion* spring to vivid life. A good panel, suitable for all possible uses, the only bitter pill will be the price—Rs 17,500 which we feel is a couple of thousand more than an ideal price.

Intex IT1904W*Well built!*

This one is making a second round over to our labs after last year. With an excellent stand, good build quality and a nice finish the aesthetics are well cov-